**Supplement Table 1:** Heterogeneity of exposure assessment demonstrated (exemplified) on studies with outcome all-cause mortality (with different categories and reference groups for statistical analysis)

| **Cohort studies with occupational sitting assessed in time continously[2]**, associated with all-cause mortality[1] | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **First Author, year[1]** | **Sitting longer than a regular work day/ overtime (>100 %)** | **Sitting 75 %–100 % of the work time** | **Sitting more than half of the work time(>50 %)** | **Sitting less than resp. up to half of the work time (>25–50 %)** | **Sitting rarely at work up to 1/4 of the work time (0–25 %)** | **Study quality[3]** (++) (+) (0) |
| Pulsford 2015 | ≥40 h/wk; HR=0.81 (0.57–1.14) | | ≥25–<40 h/wk HR=0.83 (0.66–1.25) | ≥8–<25 h/wk HR=0.93 (0.73–1.19) | Reference ≥0–<8 h/wk | ++ |
| Sakaue 2018 | Risk estimate analysed per unit of more occupational sitting HR=1.11 (1.01–1.22) | | | | | ++ |
| Van der Ploeg 2015 | ≥24 h/wk HR=1.25 (0.09–1.74) | | | Reference <24 h/wk | | ++ |
| Kikuchi 2015 | | | | >3 h/d 'longer' M: HR=0.96 (0.86–1.09); F: HR=1.15 (0.92–1.43) | Reference (<1 h/d) F: 1–3 h/d HR=1.06 (0.84–1.33) M: 1–3 h/d HR=1.00 (0.88–1.14) | + |
| Kim 2013 | | | Work sitting ≥5 h/d: F: HR=0.98 (0.90–1.08) M: HR=0.94 (0.88–1.02) | Sitting 1–4 h/d: F: HR=1.03 (0.95–1.12) M: HR=0.96 (0.90–1.03) | Reference (<1 h/d) | + |
| **Cohort studies with occupational sitting assessed as OPA**, associated with all-cause mortality[1] | | | | | | |
| **First Author, year** | **Predominantly sedentary, sitting (low OPA)** | **Sitting or standing, some walking** | **Much walking** | **Walking, some handling of material (moderate OPA)** | **Heavy manual work (high OPA)** | **Study quality[3]** (++) (+) (0) |
| Chau 2015 | Reference 'mostly sitting' | | 'Much walking' HR=0.73 (0.51–1.03) | 'Much walk and lift' HR=0.65 (0.44–0.97) | 'Heavy labour' HR=0.95 (0.64–1.40) | ++ |
| Moe 2013 | 'Mostly sedentary' HR=0.97 (0.83–1.14) | | | Reference 'much walk and lift' | 'Heavy physical work' HR=1.01 (0.84–1.22) | + |
| Stamatakis 2013 | Reference 'sitting' | 'Standing/walking' F: HR=0.68 (0.52–0.89) M: HR=0.97 (0.78–1.19) | | | | + |

Legend:
F: Females, M: Males

[1] In order of risk of bias rating (first studies rated as low risk of bias) and alphabetically

[2] Work sitting time in % based on working time of 8 hours/day resp. 40 h/week

[3] Methodological Assessment incl. risk of bias: assessment after the SIGN-checklists resulting in overall ratings of 'high quality' (++), 'acceptable quality' (+) and 'unacceptable/low quality' (0), synonymic with 'high quality' (++) / low risk of bias, 'acceptable quality' (+) / accepable risk of bias, and 'unacceptable/low quality' (0) / unacceptable risk of bias.